

Full Name:	UTD ID/Net ID:	Date:
In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global <i>Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2</i> The Scenario Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter. Your Group You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team. Your Task (about 15 minutes) 1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways. 2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders. 3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged. 4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute. Goal To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four. Your Card — China, 1 of 4 <i>(printed on RED paper)</i> Guanxi (关系) — Relationship Networks & Reciprocal Favors Guanxi is a web of personal relationships built on trust and mutual obligation — help someone today, and you can call in the favor tomorrow. Deals often close only after a real personal relationship exists; a great product with zero guanxi can sit on the shelf while a mediocre one with the right connections flies off it. Building guanxi takes time: repeated meals, small gifts, and introductions through mutual contacts. Bring to your group: How should Armadillo Bite find its "way in" before it even pitches a single bag of chips? Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):		

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — China, 2 of 4 *(printed on RED paper)*

Mianzi (面子) — Face & Social Standing

"Face" is a person's public dignity and reputation. Giving someone face — public praise, deference, a generous gesture — builds goodwill; causing someone to lose face (a public correction, hard public haggling, bluntly rejecting a gift) can quietly kill a deal. Companies that let their local partners look good in front of their own boss earn outsized goodwill.

Bring to your group: *How can Armadillo Bite's launch event make its local partners look good in front of their own bosses?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — China, 3 of 4 *(printed on RED paper)*

Hierarchy & Group Harmony

Meetings tend to follow visible seniority — the most senior person present is greeted and addressed first — and open disagreement in front of the group is avoided in favor of harmony; real objections often surface later, privately. A foreign team that skips straight to "the decision-maker" or forces a public yes/no on the spot can badly misread the room.

Bring to your group: *How should Armadillo Bite's sales team structure a first meeting so it respects seniority and doesn't force an uncomfortable public answer?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — China, 4 of 4 *(printed on RED paper)*

Gift-Giving & Banquet Rituals

Sharing a meal — often a long, multi-course banquet with toasts — is where real trust gets built, more than in the boardroom. Gifts are common and expected, but must be chosen with care: certain numbers carry meaning (8 is lucky; 4 is not), and certain items (like clocks) are traditionally avoided as gifts.

Bring to your group: What would a "welcome banquet" or launch gift for Armadillo Bite's new partners look like — and what should the team avoid bringing to the table (literally)?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Brazil, 1 of 4 *(printed on GREEN paper)*

Jeitinho Brasileiro — The Creative Workaround

The "jeitinho" is the very Brazilian art of finding a clever, flexible way around a rule or bureaucratic obstacle — resourceful improvisation, not quite cheating. Brazilian bureaucracy (customs, permits, registrations) can be famously slow and tangled, and Brazilians are famous for finding a warm, relationship-based shortcut through it rather than waiting in line.

Bring to your group: What's the "jeitinho" version of getting Armadillo Bite's first shipment through customs — and who do you need to befriend to find it?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Brazil, 2 of 4 *(printed on GREEN paper)*

Personalismo — Business Runs on Personal Trust

In Brazil, people do business with people, not with logos. A real personal relationship usually needs to exist before any contract is signed — small talk, personal questions, and warmth aren't a delay before "real business," they ARE the real business. A cold, purely transactional pitch (email a proposal, expect a fast yes) usually goes nowhere.

Bring to your group: What does Armadillo Bite's very first meeting with a Brazilian distributor need to include before anyone mentions price or contracts?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Brazil, 3 of 4 *(printed on GREEN paper)*

Family & Informal Business Networks

Many Brazilian businesses — especially outside the largest firms — are family-run or built on tight social circles, and real decisions often flow through family relationships rather than the official org chart. An outsider who identifies and respects the real decision-maker (who might not hold the official title) moves faster than one who only reads the business card.

Bring to your group: How should Armadillo Bite figure out who the real decision-maker is inside a family-run distributor?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Brazil, 4 of 4 *(printed on GREEN paper)*

Warmth, Touch & Expressive Communication

Brazilian business culture tends to be high-contact and expressive — closer physical proximity, a touch on the arm while talking, an animated tone, and genuine warmth are normal and expected, not unprofessional. A stiff, arm's-length American style can come across as cold or untrustworthy.

Bring to your group: *How should Armadillo Bite coach its sales rep to greet a new partner so it doesn't feel like a cold American handshake-and-leave?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Saudi Arabia, 1 of 4 *(printed on GOLD / YELLOW paper)*

Wasta (واسطة) — Connections & Influence

Wasta is the power of who you know — a trusted introduction from the right person can open a door that a cold pitch never will, and much of business runs through networks of family, tribe, and long-standing personal relationships. A foreign company that arrives with no local introduction starts several steps behind one that arrives vouched for.

Bring to your group: *Who should introduce Armadillo Bite to its first retail partner, and why does it matter that it's a person and not an email?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Saudi Arabia, 2 of 4 *(printed on GOLD / YELLOW paper)*

Majlis Culture — Where Relationships Actually Form

The majlis is a traditional sitting where guests are welcomed, coffee (qahwa) and dates are shared, and conversation ranges widely before business is even mentioned. Real trust often gets built here, outside the formal meeting room — rushing straight to business is considered abrupt.

Bring to your group: *If Armadillo Bite's team is invited to a majlis, what should they expect — and what would rushing straight to a sales pitch signal about them?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Saudi Arabia, 3 of 4 *(printed on GOLD / YELLOW paper)*

Hospitality & Patience as Trust Signals

Generous hospitality (coffee, tea, food) is a genuine cultural value and, quietly, a small test — how a guest receives it says something about their character. Business timelines can be longer than Western norms; pushing hard for a fast decision can read as disrespectful rather than efficient.

Bring to your group: How should Armadillo Bite adjust its "we need an answer by Friday" American sales instinct?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Saudi Arabia, 4 of 4 *(printed on GOLD / YELLOW paper)*

Religious & Calendar Rhythms

Business rhythms follow religious life: Friday is the holy day (the weekend shifts accordingly), prayer times pause the business day five times daily, and the pace and hours of business change significantly during Ramadan. A launch or big meeting scheduled without checking these rhythms can land at exactly the wrong moment.

Bring to your group: *What week would be the worst possible time for Armadillo Bite to schedule its big launch event — and why?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Japan, 1 of 4 *(printed on BLUE paper)*

Wa (和) — Group Harmony Over Individual Assertion

Wa is the value placed on group harmony — smooth, non-confrontational relationships are protected even at the cost of stating an individual opinion bluntly. Disagreement is rarely stated directly in a meeting; a hesitant "that could be difficult" often quietly means no. A foreign partner who pushes hard for a direct yes/no can unintentionally create real discomfort.

Bring to your group: *If a partner says Armadillo Bite's pricing "might be a little difficult," what do they actually mean — and how should the team respond?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Japan, 2 of 4 *(printed on BLUE paper)*

Nemawashi (根回し) — Consensus-Building Behind the Scenes

Nemawashi means quietly laying the groundwork before a formal decision — informally consulting each stakeholder one-on-one ahead of time, so that by the time an official meeting happens, everyone already agrees and the meeting is really just a formality. Skipping this and hoping to win the room live, in the meeting itself, usually backfires.

Bring to your group: Before Armadillo Bite's "big pitch meeting," who should they have already quietly talked to — and why?

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Japan, 3 of 4 *(printed on BLUE paper)*

Honne and Tatemaie — Private Truth vs. Public Face

Honne is what someone privately thinks; tatemaie is the polite, socially appropriate thing said out loud. A partner may express polite interest (tatemaie) in a meeting while privately holding real reservations (honne) that only surface later, through indirect signals or a trusted go-between.

Bring to your group: *How can Armadillo Bite's team learn what their partner really thinks, if the polite public answer might not be the whole story?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Japan, 4 of 4 *(printed on BLUE paper)*

Ringi & Slow, Careful Decision-Making

The ringi system circulates a written proposal through every relevant department for review and approval before a final decision — thorough, bottom-up, and often slower than a "the boss decides today" style, but it builds buy-in across the whole organization once approved. Rushing this process can be read as disrespectful of how the company actually works.

Bring to your group: *How should Armadillo Bite set its expectations for how long a "yes" might take — and why might that be a good thing once it finally arrives?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Russia, 1 of 4 *(printed on PURPLE / LAVENDER paper)*

Blat (блат) — Informal Networks & Favor Exchange

Blat is the long Russian tradition of getting things done through a personal network of connections and favors rather than official channels — born from decades of scarcity, it's still very alive in business today, from clearing customs to finding a reliable local partner. Arriving with no one who "knows someone" makes ordinary hurdles much harder to clear.

Bring to your group: *Who should Armadillo Bite lean on to find a distributor who actually knows how to move product through the system?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Russia, 2 of 4 *(printed on PURPLE / LAVENDER paper)*

Personal Guarantees Matter More Than Paperwork

A signed contract is expected, but it's the personal relationship and reputation behind it that Russian partners actually trust — a stranger's signature on a page means less than a known, vouched-for person's word. Deals often move faster once real trust is established, and slower (or nowhere) without it, no matter how solid the paperwork looks.

Bring to your group: *Before Armadillo Bite sends over a formal contract, what should the team do first to earn real trust, not just a signature?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Russia, 3 of 4 *(printed on PURPLE / LAVENDER paper)*

Concentrated, Top-Down Decision-Making

Decision-making authority tends to sit clearly at the top; mid-level staff often can't (or won't) commit to anything meaningful without sign-off from above. A foreign team that spends weeks building rapport with a mid-level contact, only to learn that person can't actually approve anything, has wasted valuable time.

Bring to your group: *How can Armadillo Bite figure out early who the real decision-maker is, instead of spending a month with the wrong person?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):

Full Name:

UTD ID/Net ID:

Date:

In-Class Activity 7 — Armadillo Bite Goes Global

Informal Institutions in Action — Week 4, Session 2

The Scenario

Armadillo Bite is a small-batch spicy kettle chip company made in Texas. It's a runaway hit across the US — gas stations, grocery stores, even a cult following on campus. The founders now want to go global: open a wholly owned sales subsidiary in a new country and sell the exact same chips there, exported straight from Texas. There's just one problem: Armadillo Bite has never sold a single bag outside the US, and the founders know nothing about the unwritten rules of how business actually gets done in the country they're about to enter.

Your Group

You are Armadillo Bite's entry team for one country. Your group has 4 members, and each of you has one sheet like this one — same scenario, same instructions, but a different card at the bottom. Every card in your group covers the SAME country, but a different informal institution. Don't skip ahead to your teammates' cards — your job in Step 2 is to teach YOUR card to the rest of the team.

Your Task (about 15 minutes)

1. Read your own card (below) silently and jot down 2–3 key takeaways.
2. Go around the group — each person has about two minutes to "teach" their card to the rest of the team. No reading it verbatim; explain it like you're briefing the founders.
3. As a group, combine all four cards into: (a) one or two sentences on how Armadillo Bite should adjust its entry strategy for this country given these informal institutions, and (b) one marketing slogan for Armadillo Bite, localized to fit the cultural nuances your team just learned. Wordplay, translation jokes, and genuine cleverness are all encouraged.
4. Be ready to share your slogan and your single best strategic insight with the class in about 1 minute.

Goal

To turn textbook talk about informal institutions — culture, norms, and unwritten rules — into a real go-to-market decision, and to see firsthand how much worse the plan would have been if your team had only heard one of the four cards instead of all four.

Your Card — Russia, 4 of 4 *(printed on PURPLE / LAVENDER paper)*

Slow to Trust, Direct Once Trusted

Earning trust can take a real getting-to-know-you period — small talk and pleasantries are not the norm early on. But once trust is established, communication tends to become notably direct and blunt, and shared meals or toasts often mark the moment the relationship has shifted from formal to real.

Bring to your group: *How should Armadillo Bite's team read the moment when a cautious, formal contact suddenly becomes blunt and direct — and what should they do differently once that happens?*

Responses (write your group's final strategy line + slogan):